ORANGE ENGLISH

FREE VOCABULARY GUIDE AND EXERCISE BOOK

IELTS topics for 2027

11 topics to practise for Writing Task 2 and Speaking Part 3, with phrases, exercises and planning pages.

- Screen time and children
- The cost of housing
- AI in study and work
- Remote and hybrid work
- Ageing populations
- Loneliness
- Misinformation online
- Adapting to climate change
- Fast fashion
- The gig economy
- Surveillance and privacy

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BEFORE YOU START

How to use this book

Nobody outside IELTS knows which questions you will get in 2027. These eleven topics are issues that are likely to appear inside familiar IELTS themes such as education, work, health and government spending. All the questions are original Orange English practice questions.

Learn each expression as a whole phrase. Knowing the word *deposit* is useful. Being able to say *save for a deposit on a flat* gives you something you can use in an answer straight away.

1. **Read the phrases** and say each example sentence aloud.
2. **Do Exercise A and B** without looking back, then check the answer key.
3. **Plan the question** using at least three phrases from the topic.
4. **Write or speak your answer.** For Writing, give yourself 40 minutes. For Speaking, answer aloud for about a minute and record yourself.
5. **Listen back for "it depends".** Depends on what? The words you say next are often where your answer gets interesting.

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01 TOPIC 1 OF 11 Screen time and children

School phone bans and age limits on social media fit easily into education and family questions.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
excessive screen time	too many hours spent looking at phones, tablets or computers	*Excessive screen time has been linked to poor sleep in teenagers.*
be easily distracted	lose concentration quickly	*Students with phones on their desks are easily distracted by notifications.*
impose a ban on	officially stop something from being allowed	*Some schools have imposed a ban on phones during lessons.*
cyberbullying	bullying that happens online	*Cyberbullying can continue after the school day has ended.*
digital literacy	the ability to use technology safely and effectively	*Digital literacy is now as important as reading and writing.*
enforce a rule	make sure people follow a rule	*A ban only works if teachers are able to enforce the rule.*
parental supervision	parents watching and guiding what children do	*Young children should only use social media with parental supervision.*
face-to-face interaction	talking to people in person	*Break times give children valuable face-to-face interaction.*
set limits on screen time	decide how long someone can use a device	*Parents can set limits on screen time, although it can be difficult to separate homework from entertainment.*
an age restriction	a rule about how old someone must be	*An age restriction on social media is only useful if platforms check users' ages.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

enforce | cyberbullying | digital literacy | excessive screen time | face-to-face interaction

1. Without _____, children may not develop the social skills they need as adults.
2. Banning phones completely could prevent students from developing _____.
3. It is difficult to _____ a phone ban when students carry phones in their pockets.
4. _____ can lead to tiredness, poor posture and lower grades.
5. Victims of _____ often feel they cannot escape, even at home.

EXERCISE B

Upgrade the sentence

Rewrite this weak sentence using at least two phrases from the vocabulary list.

> Phones are bad for kids because they can't focus and they don't talk to people.

PLAN IT · WRITING TASK 2

Some people think students should be required to leave their mobile phones at home on school days. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

My position

Main idea 1 + example

Main idea 2 + example

Phrases I'll use

Plan for 5 minutes, then write at least 250 words in 35 minutes.

02 TOPIC 2 OF 11 The cost of housing

Housing connects to government spending, cities and young people's futures.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
a housing shortage	not enough homes for the people who need them	*Many capital cities face a serious housing shortage.*
soaring property prices	house prices that rise very quickly	*Soaring property prices have pushed young families out of the city.*
get on the property ladder	buy your first home	*It is increasingly difficult for young adults to get on the property ladder.*
affordable housing	homes that people on average incomes can pay for	*Developers should be required to include affordable housing in new projects.*
rent controls	legal limits on how much rents can rise	*Rent controls protect tenants but may discourage new building.*
social housing	homes provided at low rent by the government or charities	*Building more social housing would help low-income families.*
first-time buyers	people buying a home for the first time	*Some governments offer tax benefits to first-time buyers.*
demand outstrips supply	more people want something than is available	*Prices rise when demand outstrips supply.*
save for a deposit	put money aside for the first payment on a home	*Rising rents make it harder for young adults to save for a deposit.*
be priced out of an area	find that prices have risen beyond what you can afford	*Even people who grew up in the neighbourhood can be priced out of it.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

soaring property prices | social housing | demand outstrips supply | first-time buyers | rent controls

1. In popular cities, _____, so even small flats are expensive.
2. _____ mean that many young people are still living with their parents in their thirties.
3. Governments could help _____ by offering low-interest loans.
4. Investing in _____ would give low-income families a secure place to live.
5. Critics argue that _____ reduce the number of homes available to rent.

EXERCISE B

Cause or solution?

Sort these points into causes of high housing costs and possible solutions.

a housing shortage | build more social housing | investors buying homes to rent out | introduce rent controls | population growth in cities | help for first-time buyers

CAUSE	SOLUTION

PLAN IT · WRITING TASK 2

In some cities, young adults are finding it increasingly difficult to afford a home of their own. Why might this be the case? What could be done to help?

My position _____

Main idea 1 + example _____

Main idea 2 + example _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Plan for 5 minutes, then write at least 250 words in 35 minutes.

03 TOPIC 3 OF 11
AI in study and work

AI questions usually connect to study or work, not technology on its own.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
automate routine tasks	use machines or software to do repetitive work	*Many companies now automate routine tasks such as data entry.*
job displacement	the loss of jobs when technology takes over the work	*Job displacement is a real concern for people in administrative roles.*
retrain workers	teach people the skills for a different job	*Governments could fund courses to retrain workers whose jobs disappear.*
personalised learning	teaching adapted to each student's level and needs	*AI tools can offer personalised learning at a pace that suits each student.*
instant feedback	comments or corrections given immediately	*Students who receive instant feedback can correct mistakes before they become habits.*
over-reliance on technology	depending on technology too much	*Over-reliance on technology may weaken students' problem-solving skills.*
critical thinking skills	the ability to analyse and judge information carefully	*Schools need to develop critical thinking skills, not just memory.*
raise ethical concerns	cause worries about what is right or fair	*The use of AI in hiring decisions raises ethical concerns.*
rely on a tool	depend on it, sometimes too much	*Students who rely on AI tools for every answer may stop checking their own work.*
develop independent thinking	learn to work things out for yourself	*Homework should help children develop independent thinking.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

job displacement | instant feedback | personalised learning | over-reliance on technology | retrain workers

1. Online writing tools give students _____, so they do not have to wait days for a teacher's comments.
2. If factories continue to automate, _____ will increase in manufacturing regions.
3. One solution is for companies to _____ instead of making them redundant.
4. _____ allows weaker students to review basic grammar while stronger students move on.
5. Teachers worry that _____ will make students less able to think for themselves.

EXERCISE B

Match the verbs to the nouns

Draw a line to match each verb with a noun.

raise	routine tasks
automate	staff
develop	ethical concerns
receive	instant feedback
retrain	critical thinking skills

PLAN IT · WRITING TASK 2

Some people think students should be allowed to use AI tools to help with their homework. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

My position _____

Main idea 1 + example _____

Main idea 2 + example _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Plan for 5 minutes, then write at least 250 words in 35 minutes.

04 TOPIC 4 OF 11 Remote and hybrid work

Working from home is now permanent for many people, so questions may look at workers, companies and cities.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
work remotely	work from home or another place away from the office	*Many software developers now work remotely full-time.*
hybrid working	splitting the week between home and the office	*Hybrid working gives employees more choice about where they work.*
commuting time	time spent travelling to and from work	*Working from home saves hours of commuting time each week.*
work–life balance	a healthy division between work and personal life	*Flexible hours can improve employees' work–life balance.*
a sense of isolation	a feeling of being alone and disconnected	*Some remote workers develop a sense of isolation.*
boost productivity	increase how much work is done	*Fewer interruptions at home can boost productivity.*
company culture	the shared values and habits of a workplace	*It is harder to build a strong company culture when staff rarely meet.*
city centre businesses	shops and cafés in the central area of a city	*City centre businesses lose customers when offices are empty.*
commute to work	travel regularly between home and work	*A shorter commute to work would give me more time with my family.*
learn from colleagues	develop skills by working with other people	*New employees learn from colleagues by watching how they solve problems.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

commuting time | boost productivity | company culture | a sense of isolation | hybrid working

1. Employees who live far from the office benefit most from reduced _____.
2. New staff may struggle to understand the _____ if they never meet colleagues.
3. _____ is a compromise between full-time office work and working from home.
4. Without regular contact, remote workers can develop _____.
5. Quiet working conditions at home can _____ for tasks that need concentration.

EXERCISE B

Advantage or disadvantage?

Sort these points into advantages and disadvantages of working from home.

saves commuting time | a sense of isolation | fewer interruptions | weaker company culture | lower office costs | empty city centres

ADVANTAGE	DISADVANTAGE

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

How might working from home affect people who are starting their first job?

My answer _____

A specific example _____

It depends on... _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

05 TOPIC 5 OF 11 Ageing populations

People are living longer and many countries have fewer young workers, a natural update to older-people questions.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
an ageing population	a population with a growing proportion of older people	*Japan has one of the most rapidly ageing populations in the world.*
life expectancy	the average number of years a person is expected to live	*Life expectancy has risen thanks to better healthcare.*
raise the retirement age	make people work until they are older	*Some governments have decided to raise the retirement age to 67.*
put pressure on	create difficulties or demands for	*More elderly patients put pressure on hospitals.*
the state pension	regular money the government pays to retired people	*The state pension is becoming more expensive to fund.*
the working-age population	people old enough and young enough to work	*A smaller working-age population means fewer taxpayers.*
elderly care	looking after older people	*Families often struggle to pay for elderly care.*
a shrinking workforce	fewer people available to work	*Immigration is one response to a shrinking workforce.*
provide unpaid care	look after someone without being paid	*People who provide unpaid care for a partner may find it difficult to work full-time.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

life expectancy | the working-age population | raise the retirement age | elderly care | put pressure on

1. As _____ increases, people spend more years in retirement.
2. An ageing population will _____ healthcare systems.
3. If _____ shrinks, there will be fewer people paying taxes.
4. One option is to _____, so that people work for longer.
5. Many adults combine full-time jobs with _____ for their parents.

EXERCISE B

Correct the mistake

Each sentence has one vocabulary mistake. Find it and correct it.

1. The life expectation in most countries has increased.
2. Many countries now have an aged population.
3. The government plans to rise the retirement age.
4. Older people put pressure to public services.
5. The pension state is paid to everyone over 67.

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

Should everyone be expected to retire at the same age?

My answer _____

A specific example _____

It depends on... _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

06 TOPIC 6 OF 11 Loneliness

People are more connected online than ever, yet many feel alone. This suits causes and solutions questions.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
social isolation	having little contact with other people	*Social isolation is common among elderly people who live alone.*
feel isolated	feel alone and cut off from others	*Students who move abroad often feel isolated at first.*
superficial connections	relationships that are not deep or meaningful	*Social media can create many superficial connections.*
meaningful relationships	close relationships that matter to us	*Meaningful relationships are built through shared time and experiences.*
live alone	live without other people in the home	*More adults than ever choose to live alone.*
community spaces	public places where local people can meet	*Libraries and parks are important community spaces.*
mental wellbeing	a healthy state of mind	*Regular contact with friends supports mental wellbeing.*
a sense of belonging	a feeling of being accepted as part of a group	*Clubs and volunteering can give people a sense of belonging.*
a support network	a group of people you can turn to for help	*It takes time to build a support network when you move to a new city.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

superficial connections | community spaces | a sense of belonging | live alone | mental wellbeing

1. More people now _____, especially in large cities.
2. Having hundreds of online followers often means _____ rather than real friendships.
3. Local councils could invest in _____ such as libraries and community centres.
4. Joining a sports team can give newcomers _____.
5. Long periods of loneliness can damage people's _____.

EXERCISE B

Upgrade the sentence

Rewrite this weak sentence using at least two phrases from the vocabulary list.

> People have lots of friends online but they are still lonely because the friends are not real.

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

Why might someone who is in regular contact with other people still feel lonely?

My answer

A specific example

It depends on...

Phrases I'll use

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

07 TOPIC 7 OF 11 Misinformation online

False information spreads quickly, and AI makes fake content easier to create. Expect questions about responsibility.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
spread misinformation	share false or misleading information	*Some accounts deliberately spread misinformation about health.*
fake news	false stories presented as real news	*Fake news can influence how people vote.*
verify information	check that information is true	*Readers should verify information before sharing it.*
media literacy	the ability to judge the reliability of media	*Media literacy should be taught in secondary schools.*
regulate social media platforms	control platforms through laws or rules	*Some argue that governments must regulate social media platforms.*
freedom of speech	the right to express opinions without punishment	*Removing posts may limit freedom of speech.*
trust in the media	how much people believe news sources	*Trust in the media has fallen in many countries.*
deepfakes	realistic fake videos or images made with AI	*Deepfakes make it harder to know what is real.*
a misleading headline	a headline that gives readers the wrong impression	*A misleading headline can change how readers interpret an accurate photograph.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

verify information | freedom of speech | media literacy | deepfakes | trust in the media

1. Teaching _____ helps young people recognise unreliable sources.
2. Strict controls on online content could threaten _____.
3. Before sharing a post, users should _____ using a reliable source.
4. When people see false stories every day, their _____ declines.
5. AI has made _____ so realistic that even experts can be fooled.

EXERCISE B

Match the verbs to the nouns

Draw a line to match each verb with a noun.

spread	social media platforms
verify	trust in the media
regulate	misinformation
protect	freedom of speech
restore	information

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

Who should be responsible for checking whether information shared online is accurate?

My answer _____

A specific example _____

It depends on… _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

08 TOPIC 8 OF 11 Adapting to climate change

Environment questions are common. The newer angle is adaptation: how places cope with extreme weather.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
extreme weather events	floods, storms, heatwaves and droughts	*Extreme weather events are becoming more frequent.*
adapt to climate change	change how we live to cope with a warmer climate	*Coastal cities must adapt to climate change.*
flood defences	barriers that protect land from flooding	*The Netherlands has invested heavily in flood defences.*
heatwaves	periods of unusually hot weather	*Heatwaves are particularly dangerous for older people.*
reduce carbon emissions	produce less carbon dioxide	*Switching to renewable energy helps reduce carbon emissions.*
urban green spaces	parks and areas with plants in cities	*Urban green spaces help to cool cities in summer.*
long-term planning	deciding now what will be needed in the future	*Adaptation requires long-term planning and investment.*
international cooperation	countries working together	*Climate change cannot be solved without international cooperation.*
provide shade	create an area sheltered from the sun	*Trees can provide shade along the route children walk to school.*
reduce the risk of flooding	make flooding less likely	*Green roofs can reduce the risk of flooding in city centres.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

flood defences | urban green spaces | reduce carbon emissions | international cooperation | extreme weather events

1. Planting trees and creating _____ can lower temperatures in city centres.
2. Low-lying countries need strong _____ to protect homes and farmland.
3. No single country can stop global warming, so _____ is essential.
4. Adaptation is necessary, but we must also _____ to prevent further warming.
5. Insurance costs are rising because of more frequent _____.

EXERCISE B

Prevention or adaptation?

Sort these actions into preventing climate change and adapting to it.

build flood defences | switch to renewable energy | create urban green spaces | reduce carbon emissions | cut meat consumption | design buildings for heatwaves

PREVENTION	ADAPTATION

PLAN IT · WRITING TASK 2

Some people believe city governments should spend more money preparing for extreme weather. To what extent do you agree or disagree?

My position _____

Main idea 1 + example _____

Main idea 2 + example _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Plan for 5 minutes, then write at least 250 words in 35 minutes.

09 TOPIC 9 OF 11 Fast fashion

Questions about waste and spending often focus on clothes: why we buy so many and throw them away so quickly.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
fast fashion	cheap, fashionable clothes produced quickly	*Fast fashion lets shoppers follow trends at a low price.*
throwaway culture	a habit of using things briefly and then discarding them	*Cheap clothing has encouraged a throwaway culture.*
wear out	become unusable through repeated use	*Low-quality trainers can wear out within a few months.*
extend the life of a garment	make a piece of clothing last longer	*Replacing the lining can extend the life of a coat.*
repair rather than replace	fix something instead of buying a new one	*Free repair cafés encourage people to repair rather than replace.*
second-hand clothing	clothes that someone else owned before	*Second-hand clothing is popular with students on a budget.*
end up in landfill	be thrown away and buried as rubbish	*Millions of unwanted garments end up in landfill every year.*
impulse buying	buying things suddenly without planning	*Online sales and adverts encourage impulse buying.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

end up in landfill | second-hand clothing | extend the life of | throwaway culture | wear out

1. Millions of cheap T-shirts _____ every year.
2. Buying _____ is one way to reduce textile waste.
3. A simple repair can _____ a garment by several years.
4. Low prices have created a _____ in which clothes are worn only a few times.
5. Shoes made from cheap materials tend to _____ quickly.

EXERCISE B

Correct the mistake

Each sentence has one vocabulary mistake. Find it and correct it.

1. Many unwanted clothes finish in landfill.
2. People throw clothes away when they are worn off.
3. We should extend the live of our clothes.
4. Second-handed clothes are becoming more popular.
5. Fast fashion has created a throw culture.

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

Why do people sometimes replace clothes they could repair?

My answer _____

A specific example _____

It depends on… _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

10 TOPIC 10 OF 11 The gig economy

App-based work raises questions about freedom, pay and security that fit easily into work and employment topics.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
the gig economy	work made up of short jobs, often arranged through apps	*Delivery riders and freelance drivers are part of the gig economy.*
flexible working hours	being able to choose when you work	*Students value flexible working hours that fit around lectures.*
an unpredictable income	earnings that vary in ways that are hard to plan for	*An unpredictable income makes it difficult to budget.*
job security	being able to count on continued employment	*Permanent contracts offer more job security than app-based work.*
be self-employed	work for yourself rather than an employer	*Gig workers who are self-employed must arrange their own pensions.*
employment rights	legal protections such as sick pay and holiday pay	*Many gig workers lack basic employment rights.*
take on short-term work	accept jobs that last only a short time	*Some people take on short-term work between permanent jobs.*
earn extra income	make money in addition to a main job	*Many people drive for ride-hailing apps to earn extra income.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

job security | an unpredictable income | employment rights | flexible working hours | self-employed

1. Students often like _____ because they can work around their lectures.
2. Because most gig workers are _____, they usually have to arrange their own pension.
3. With _____, it is hard to plan a monthly budget.
4. Many gig workers lack basic _____ such as sick pay.
5. Permanent contracts offer more _____ than app-based work.

EXERCISE B

Advantage or disadvantage?

Sort these points into advantages and disadvantages of gig work.

choose your own hours | no sick pay | work for several companies | an unpredictable income | easy to start | little job security

ADVANTAGE	DISADVANTAGE

PLAN IT · WRITING TASK 2

Some people prefer to earn money by taking on short jobs whenever they choose. Do the advantages of this way of working outweigh the disadvantages?

My position _____

Main idea 1 + example _____

Main idea 2 + example _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Plan for 5 minutes, then write at least 250 words in 35 minutes.

TOPIC 11 OF 11

11 Surveillance and privacy

Cameras and data collection raise a clear trade-off between safety and freedom, which works well in both Writing and Speaking.

PHRASE	MEANING	EXAMPLE YOU COULD ADAPT
security cameras	cameras that record public or private places	*Security cameras are now common at stations and shopping centres.*
deter crime	make people less likely to commit crime	*Visible cameras may deter crime in car parks.*
collect personal data	gather information about individuals	*Many apps collect personal data without users noticing.*
an invasion of privacy	an unwelcome intrusion into someone's private life	*Some customers would see cameras in a café as an invasion of privacy.*
facial recognition technology	software that identifies people from their faces	*Facial recognition technology can identify suspects in crowds.*
store footage	keep recorded video	*Rules should limit how long companies can store footage.*
strike a balance between	find a fair middle point between two things	*Laws must strike a balance between safety and freedom.*
misuse of data	using information in a wrong or harmful way	*Strict laws can reduce the risk of misuse of data.*

Try it: cover the meanings and examples, then use each phrase in a sentence about your own country or city.

Practice

EXERCISE A

Complete the sentences

Use each phrase once. You may need to change capital letters.

deter crime | an invasion of privacy | strike a balance | store footage | misuse of data

1. Visible cameras may _____ because criminals fear being recorded.
2. Many people would see cameras inside a café as _____.
3. Governments need to _____ between public safety and personal freedom.
4. Rules should limit how long companies can _____.
5. Strict laws can reduce the risk of _____ by technology companies.

EXERCISE B

Match the verbs to the nouns

Draw a line to match each verb with a noun.

deter	footage
collect	a balance
strike	public safety
store	crime
protect	personal data

PLAN IT · SPEAKING PART 3

How do you think people feel about security cameras in public places?

My answer _____

A specific example _____

It depends on… _____

Phrases I'll use _____

Make notes for 1 minute, then answer aloud for 1 to 2 minutes.

CHECK YOUR WORK

Answer key

01 · Screen time and children

A

1. face-to-face interaction
2. digital literacy
3. enforce
4. Excessive screen time
5. cyberbullying

B

Model answer: Excessive screen time can harm children's development, as they become easily distracted in class and have fewer opportunities for face-to-face interaction.

02 · The cost of housing

A

1. demand outstrips supply
2. Soaring property prices
3. first-time buyers
4. social housing
5. rent controls

B

Cause: a housing shortage, investors buying homes to rent out, population growth in cities

Solution: build more social housing, introduce rent controls, help for first-time buyers

03 · AI in study and work

A

1. instant feedback
2. job displacement
3. retrain workers
4. Personalised learning
5. over-reliance on technology

B

1. raise ethical concerns
2. automate routine tasks
3. develop critical thinking skills
4. receive instant feedback
5. retrain staff

04 · Remote and hybrid work

A

1. commuting time
2. company culture
3. Hybrid working
4. a sense of isolation
5. boost productivity

B

Advantage: saves commuting time, fewer interruptions, lower office costs

Disadvantage: a sense of isolation, weaker company culture, empty city centres

05 · Ageing populations

A

1. life expectancy
2. put pressure on
3. the working-age population
4. raise the retirement age
5. elderly care

B

1. life expectation → life expectancy
2. an aged population → an ageing population
3. rise → raise
4. put pressure to → put pressure on
5. pension state → state pension

06 · Loneliness

A

1. live alone
2. superficial connections
3. community spaces
4. a sense of belonging
5. mental wellbeing

B

Model answer: Although many people have large online networks, these are often superficial connections, so they may still feel isolated without meaningful relationships.

CHECK YOUR WORK

Answer key (continued)

07 · Misinformation online

A

1. media literacy
2. freedom of speech
3. verify information
4. trust in the media
5. deepfakes

B

1. spread misinformation
2. verify information
3. regulate social media platforms
4. protect freedom of speech
5. restore trust in the media

08 · Adapting to climate change

A

1. urban green spaces
2. flood defences
3. international cooperation
4. reduce carbon emissions
5. extreme weather events

B

Prevention: switch to renewable energy, reduce carbon emissions, cut meat consumption

Adaptation: build flood defences, create urban green spaces, design buildings for heatwaves

09 · Fast fashion

A

1. end up in landfill
2. second-hand clothing
3. extend the life of
4. throwaway culture
5. wear out

B

1. finish in → end up in
2. worn off → worn out
3. live → life
4. Second-handed → Second-hand
5. throw culture → throwaway culture

10 · The gig economy

A

1. flexible working hours
2. self-employed
3. an unpredictable income
4. employment rights
5. job security

B

Advantage: choose your own hours, work for several companies, easy to start

Disadvantage: no sick pay, an unpredictable income, little job security

11 · Surveillance and privacy

A

1. deter crime
2. an invasion of privacy
3. strike a balance
4. store footage
5. misuse of data

B

1. deter crime
2. collect personal data
3. strike a balance
4. store footage
5. protect public safety

WHAT NEXT?

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